

The Production Game - FAQs

Orders:

1. How does the ordering system work?

There will be an "Order Board" (part of a wall) in the controllers' area, on which we will stick the Sales Order and Delivery Notices (SODN) (see appendix in the game brief). A representative of each team can ask for a particular order, and the notice will be handed over to them. This is normally done on a first-come-first-served basis. This obviously means that only one team can work on an order (however, similar orders may appear on the order board at a later time). The order board will have approx. 8-10 orders at any time. We will look at the order board periodically and change any orders that have not moved for some time (this is random – no definite time intervals).

2. Can we pick more than one order at a time?

In the very beginning of the game, the order controllers will make sure that each company gets maximum two orders. There is no restriction other than that. However, the company should also consider about penalties of not fulfilling a picked up order (see the brief).

3. How does a team win an order? (Or how does a team secure one or even two of the orders once they are released?) Are the orders won just on a first-come-first-served basis or do we need to undercut the price more than our rival firms?

We have a pool of orders that include greeting card orders for different occasions e.g. Christmas, Easter, birthday, etc. The orders will be released on the orders board randomly. The teams should send a nominee to pick up orders from the orders board, which will be issued on first-come-first-served basis. You don't need to undercut the price more than your rival firms.

4. In what schedule and how often do orders get released?

Random orders will be posted on the orders board for pick up by the teams on first-come-first-served basis (approx. 8-10 at a time). If some orders are not picked up by any team for a while, we will replace them with new orders from the pool.

5. What time of year do we play the game at? (Or what hypothetical time of year does the game start at? i.e. If we start playing in January we can assume the Christmas order will not come till late running of the game etc.)

The order will be released for cards of various occasions spread across the whole year. The orders will be placed on the orders board RANDOMLY so please expect any type of order to become available at any time.

Procurement:

6. How many pens are there in supply and how many can we buy?

There are a reasonable number of pens in supply. There are no restrictions on the

number of pens you can buy. However, there will be some market regulation in place, and we will make sure that no team attempts to hoard the resources and defeat the purpose of the game! This also applies to other resources such as pencils, paper, etc.

Production / Quality:

7. Are we allowed to bring pre-prepared templates?
You are allowed to bring pre-prepared paper-based templates for the production game (if you think these may be useful). You can also bring any computer analysis etc..., but no other mechanical aids can be used for the game.
8. Can we use guides made during the game out of our materials?
YES, you can make guides/templates using the materials provided.
9. Does it have to be the same handwriting inside every card in an order?
NO
10. Can we write id's/info on the envelopes before the game?
NO.
11. Can we fold the paper before the game?
NO. All production related activities have to take place during the game.
12. For an order consisting of A6 cards, must all cards have the same stencil size used for the front cover or is it ok for us to produce a mixture of 5 and 10mm stencilled cards?
All cards in an order have to be consistent. However, you may have different handwriting in the insides.
13. Can we use pencil for record keeping, envelope labelling, and filling in the SODN?
Yes.
14. Can we also use pencil instead of pen for marking the back of the card/ for the verses at all?
You can use pencils for marking the back of the card, but not for writing verses.
15. What constitutes a rhyming verse?
The only condition is that the verses must rhyme. Now it's up to the teams to come up with conventional or innovative ideas on this. As far as the company representative could convince the quality controllers that should be fine.
16. Will we be assessed on the quality of our rhymes at all?
No. The verses should rhyme, and must be specific to the event you are producing the card for.

17. Must every line have the same rhyme or can it follow coupling structures etc.? (Or can it be limerick style? etc.)

AND

Does rhyming verse mean couplets are allowed or do we have to make every line rhyme? (Really hoping the former as have an absolute cracker for Christmas!)

There is no restriction; couplets should be fine.

18. Is there a minimum number of syllables/words per line or would: "Hey!, Grey, Hay, Birthday!" count as a valid four line verse for a birthday card?

There is no such limit. This should be fine but the quality controllers will have the final say on the day.

19. Can we have some examples of how perfect, an acceptable card is?

MET Office has a collection. You can take a look while collecting your team's starter pack. We'll be bringing these to the game as well.

20. We have done a prep run for practice. Are these acceptable in terms of quality? I.e. which would be rejected? Are the lines horizontal and centered enough? Are the folds acceptable?

We can't comment on digital images unless we see the original cards. However, the quality controllers will be assessing the cards against the specifications (see the brief) and the specific sales order and delivery notice (see template in the brief). Please note that the quality controllers reserve the right to measure any required distances/gaps as per the Production Game Brief.

Overall:

21. How does a team win?

It will depend on turnover, profit and loss, delivery and quality but effectively the team making the highest profit will win. Dynamic updates on sales may be projected as soon as data becomes available to controllers. However, you will have to keep your own records on how your company is performing in terms of profit making. The controllers will only be able to release company profit data until after end of the game but before or during feedback session. However, assessment is not based on profit but will be based on your pre- and post-game reports.

22. Can we sell unwanted resources to other teams?

You can sell or exchange (barter) material with other teams.

23. What's the policy on collaboration? If an agreement can be forged between 2 teams, are we allowed to jointly fulfill an order, subject of course to uniformity of poetry?

See following excerpt from the brief: "Inter-company sales are allowed (raw materials, finished goods, outsourcing). Fill out the INTER-COMPANY TRANSACTION RECORD and submit to the financial controller - these can be obtained free of cost. Exchanges (Bartering) need not be recorded."

The final submission of an order should be through ONE company only (which

would mean the profit/loss would go to that company ONLY). In between picking and fulfilling an order, it's up to you to think about how best you could utilise the options while keeping within rules (e.g. intercompany transfers).

24. Are we allowed to bring in laptops to use during the game?

You are allowed to use laptops for record-keeping and control, but not for manufacturing (i.e. printing) the cards!

Reports

25. What should be the maximum length of pre-game and final reports?

Maximum 2,000 words each!

26. In the report document it stresses the importance of referring the text back to the course material. Does this have to be implicit or explicit? E.g. the system meant a good utilisation of the workforce OR the system meant a good utilisation (lecture 3, 3P4) of the workforce.

AND

Do the links back to our course material have to be explicit or implicit - e.g. can we simply refer to a system we developed as _poke yoke_, or does this have to be explained and referenced to a specific lecture?

Implicit is fine - we don't need direct references to lecture notes

27. In our final reports on the production game, can we refer back to the planned strategy, layout etc. in the pre-game report or do we have to summarise it? i.e. will whoever is marking the final report have a copy of the initial one?

AND

Do we have to summarise the pre-game report when we are making comparisons between reality and planning in the final report, or can we assume that markers will have the pre-game report on hand? It would be good from a word-count point of view to not have to write out things already submitted.

It needs to be [briefly] summarised and the final report should be self-contained. Of course, the marker will have knowledge of the initial reports but a second checker may not for example.